HARSHAL ZALKE

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ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Vanderbilt University 2026-27
Postdoctoral Scholar, Department of Political Science

EDUCATION

Princeton University 2026
PhD, Department of Politics
Fields:*Political Economy, Formal Theory and Quantitative Methods, International Relations*
Committee Members: *Kris Ramsay (Chair), Mehdi Shadmehr, Germán Gieczewski*

The University of Texas at Austin 2020
M.A., LBJ School of Public Affairs

The University of Texas at Austin 2018
M.S., Department of Operations Research and Industrial Engineering

Visvesvaraya National Institute of Technology, India 2014
B.Tech., Mechanical Engineering

WORKING PAPERS

- **"Coordinating Development Under Political Risk"**
(with Mehdi Shadmehr)
  - *Revise and Resubmit at American Journal of Political Science.*
- **"Security Risks and the Screening of Investments"**
(Job Market Paper)
  - *Presentations: Stanford GSB PE Seminar 2026, APSA 2026, MPSA 2026*
- **"Dynamic Screening with Hidden Harm"**
(Dissertation Chapter)
- **"The Geopolitics of Investment Screening: How Interstate Rivalry Shapes Market Access"**
(Dissertation Chapter)
- **"Strategic Investments and War Prevention"**
  - *Presentations: MPSA 2025, APSA 2024, GSIPE 2024*

SELECTED WORKS IN PROGRESS

- **"The Value of Intelligence in Conflict"**
(with Kris Ramsay)
  - *APSA 2026, MPSA 2026*
- **"Optimal Sanctions Regime"**

INVITED TALKS AND CONFERENCES

- Stanford GSB PE Seminar 2026
- American Political Science Association 2020, 2024, 2025, 2026

- Midwest Political Science Association 2024, 2025, 2026
- Graduate Students in International Political Economy Workshop 2024
- The Politics and Regulation of Investment Screening Mechanisms 2022

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

At Princeton:

- **POL 345: Introduction to Quantitative Social Science (U)**, (TA for Arthur Yu) Fall 2025
- **POL 396: International Organization (U)**, (TA for Jim Vreeland) Spring 2024
- **POL 572: Quantitative Analysis 1 (G)**, (TA for Rocio Titiunik) Spring 2023
- **POL 573: Quantitative Analysis 2 (G)**, (TA for Rocio Titiunik) Fall 2023

At UT Austin:

- **FIN 357: Business Finance (U)**, (TA for Robert Duvic) 2018 - 2020
- **STA 380: Mathematical Statistics for Applications (G)**, (TA for Thomas Sager) Fall 2017
- **PHY 103M: Laboratory for Physics (U)**, Spring 2017

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

- Research Assistant for Helen Milner, *Princeton University* Summer 2022
- Research Assistant for Layna Mosley, *Princeton University* Spring 2021
- Research Assistant for Catherine Weaver, *The University of Texas at Austin* 2019 - 2020

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- Summer Intern, *Carnegie Council for Ethics in International Affairs* Summer 2019
- Sr. Engineer (Supply Chain), *Bajaj Auto Ltd* 2014 - 2016

FELLOWSHIPS AND HONORS

- Dean's Completion Fellowship, *Princeton University* 2025-2026
- The John Fayerweather '43 Graduate Fellowship, *Princeton University* 2023-2024
- Quantitative and Analytical Political Science Fellow, *Princeton University* 2022-2026
- Niehaus Center for Globalization and Governance, *Princeton University* 2020-2021
- Lyndon Baines Johnson Foundation Fellowship, *UT Austin* Spring 2019
- Charls and Harmolyn Walker Public Policy Excellence Fund Fellowship, *UT Austin* Summer 2019

REFERENCES

- **Kristopher Ramsay**
  Professor
  Department of Politics, Princeton University
  003 Fisher Hall
  609-258-2960
  kramsay@princeton.edu

- **Mehdi Shadmehr**
  Associate Professor
  Department of Public Policy, UNC Chapel Hill
  mshadmeh@gmail.com

- **Germán Gieczewski**
  Associate Professor
  Department of Politics, Princeton University
  311 Fisher Hall
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